



Busting Governance Myths – We are not the Architecture Police!

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Few concepts cause more confusion and internal heartburn than “Governance”. Issues of authority, decision-rights, organizational boundaries and “don’t play in my sandbox” attitudes surface at the mere mention of the term. Sometimes the discussions are so challenging that they are deferred, indefinitely.

To be effective in their role, Enterprise Architects must have a thorough command of the critical elements of governance and drive it forward. They must be able to communicate the concepts to senior leadership and must facilitate the creation of the governance bodies and processes. They must also be highly pragmatic when selling, installing and operating the governance system – too little and nothing happens, too much and the enterprise bogs down in bureaucracy. The key is to evolve governance mechanisms as the organization evolves – hitting the sweet spot at every stage.

- 1. Enterprise wants to change**
 - Sometimes, 'change' is a survival imperative
- 2. Enterprises are complex and business processes are not well understood or documented**
 - Often lack adequate measurement
 - Numerous exceptions – often undocumented
- 3. Change rates are accelerating**
 - The full impact of change is unknown
- 4. Accommodating change is very expensive, time-consuming and an obstacle to success**
- 5. Information Technology is a complex and fundamental enabler, but one that is difficult to change quickly**
- 6. Systems integration is haphazard at best, non-existent at worst**
- 7. Applications and Projects are not optimally managed, if at all**
- 8. Strong desire to reduce IT costs not increase IT capital budgets**
- 9. Strong desire to 'innovate' using new technology and optimized processes – but where to begin**
- 10. Difficult to look at everything in a holistic and organized manner**

- Enterprise Governance is a consistent and interdependent system of **people**, **process**, and **policy** throughout the organization intended to ensure the **intentions of the enterprise leadership** are reflected in all decisions.
- Must be delegated authority by senior leadership
- Must understand strategy, EA and EPM; participation improves understanding
- Defines (approves) standards, policy, guidelines
- Must define consequences and apply them



Enterprise Governance Concerns



FINANCIAL

Investment and financial concerns of the enterprise. These include budgeting, portfolio investment allocation, cash flow, IT Spend, investment/equity returns, fixed vs. variable costs, risk, etc.

COMPLIANCE

The policies, principles and rules that must be followed. These include externally mandated regulatory concerns such as HIPAA, Sarbanes-Oxley, BASEL II, and internally mandated corporate/enterprise policy rules/regulations.

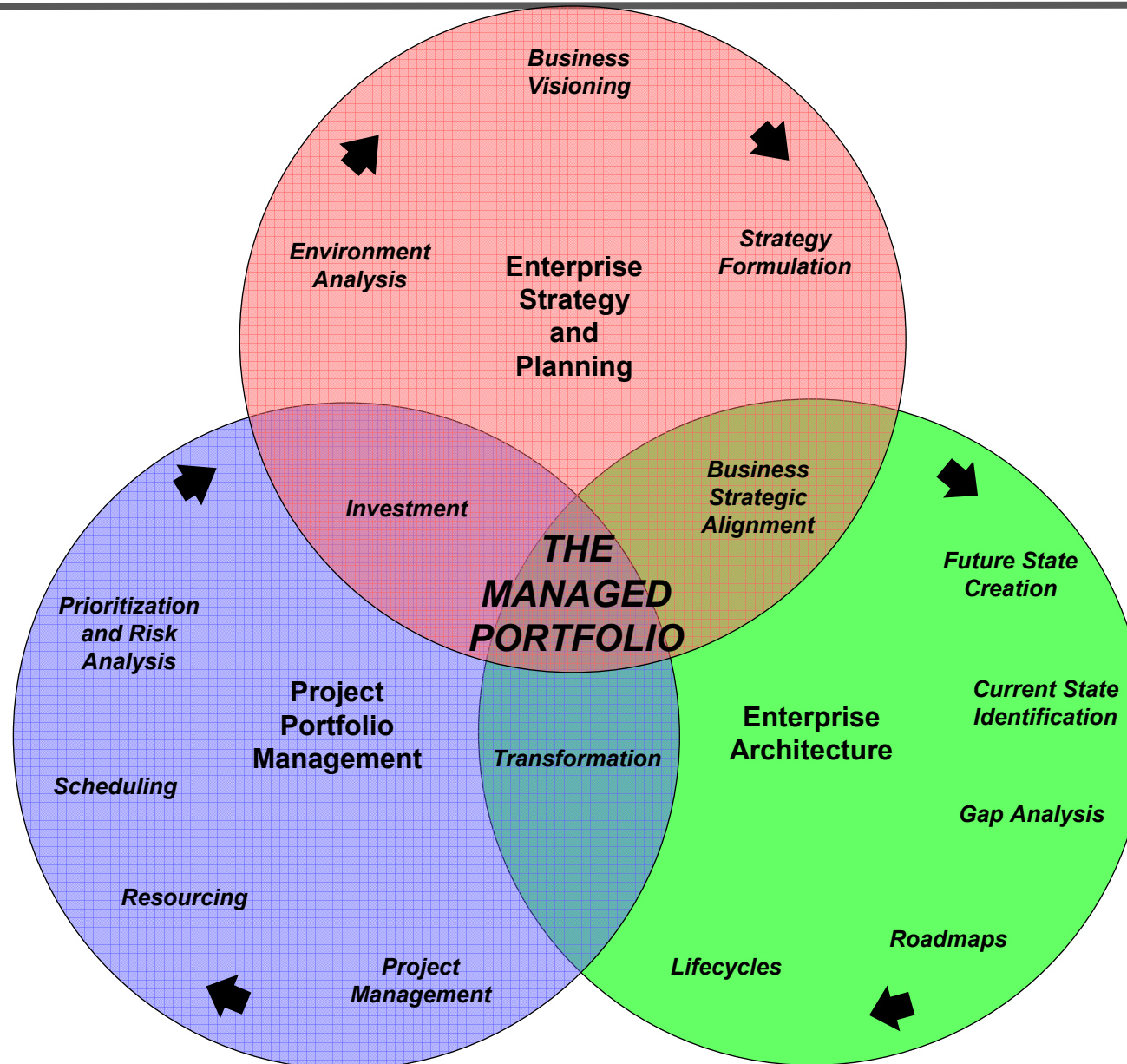
The work that must be done. These include major initiatives, individual and BU projects, asset transformation and improvement activities, project and aggregate portfolio risk, resources, etc.

The portfolios of assets we must manage and leverage to produce value to the enterprise. These include people, processes, technology, information, business capabilities, etc.

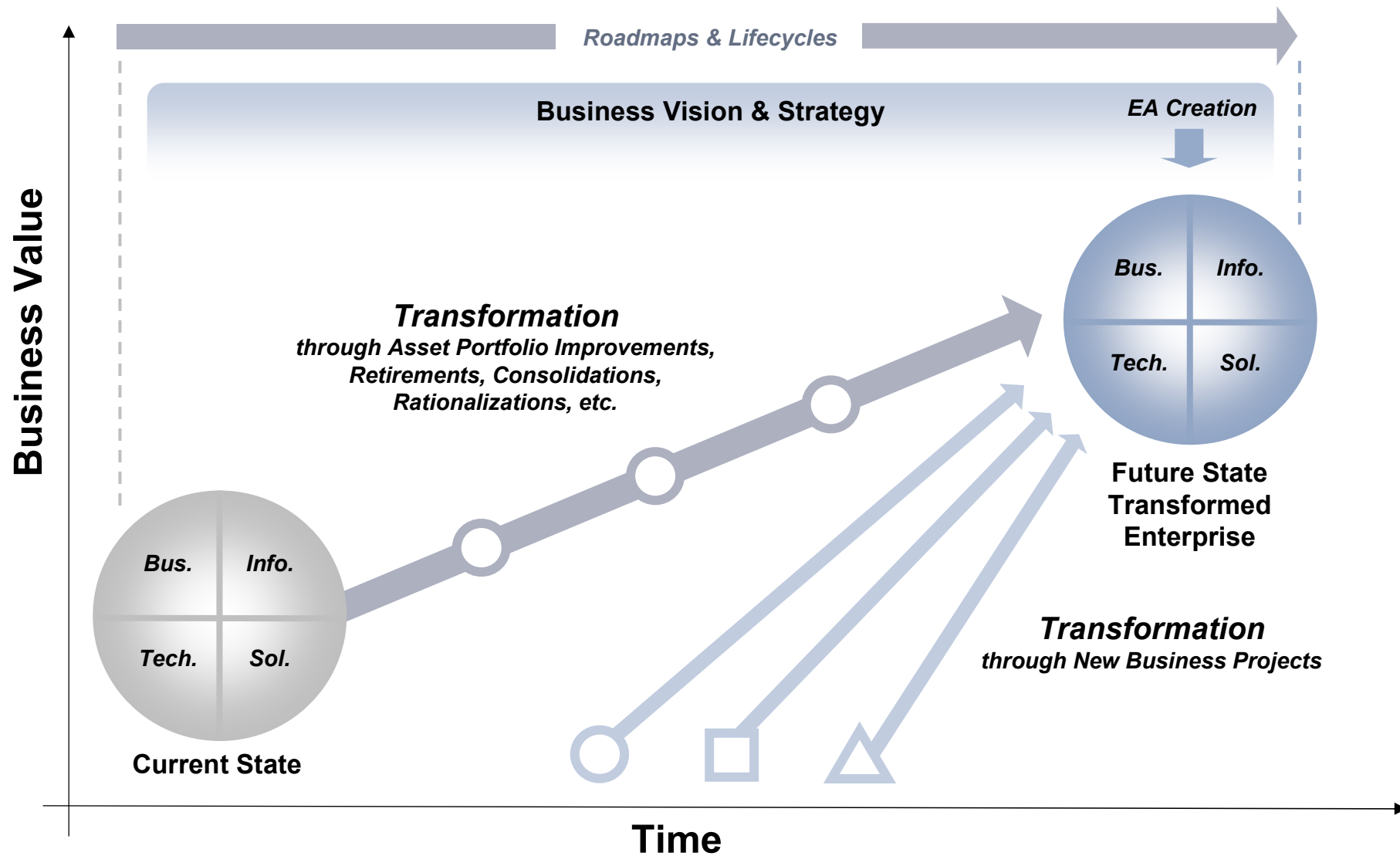
PROJECTS

ASSETS

The Portfolio Processes



EA Driving Transformation



- Expresses the impact of Business Strategy on the operations of your business, the information you need, the applications that support your business, and the infrastructure upon which they are built
- Establishes a set of principles that drives consistent decision making across disparate groups of decision makers
- Establishes/Publishes/Evolves a set of standards and guidelines from which projects and other implementation activities take direction
- Creates models that provide a broad context for impact analysis, scenario planning, reuse opportunity identification
- Compares the future state against the current state and develops a Roadmap that shows how to migrate from As-Is to To-Be
- Creates an environment of collaboration and consensus-building between management, architects, SMEs, analysts, developers and business sponsors

A Few EA Governance Myths



- **It is the enterprise architect's responsibility to police projects**
- **Enterprise architects must be part of every project team**
- **Enterprise architects create the design documents for every project and must fill out project compliance documents**
- **Solutions Architects are part of the EA team**
- **A very strong, detailed EA compliance process is critical**
- **The organization must have a PMO**
- **The organization must have a standard project process, methodology, SDLC, etc.**
- **An ARB reviews/approves every project's design**
- **An ARB is made up of the IT leadership team**

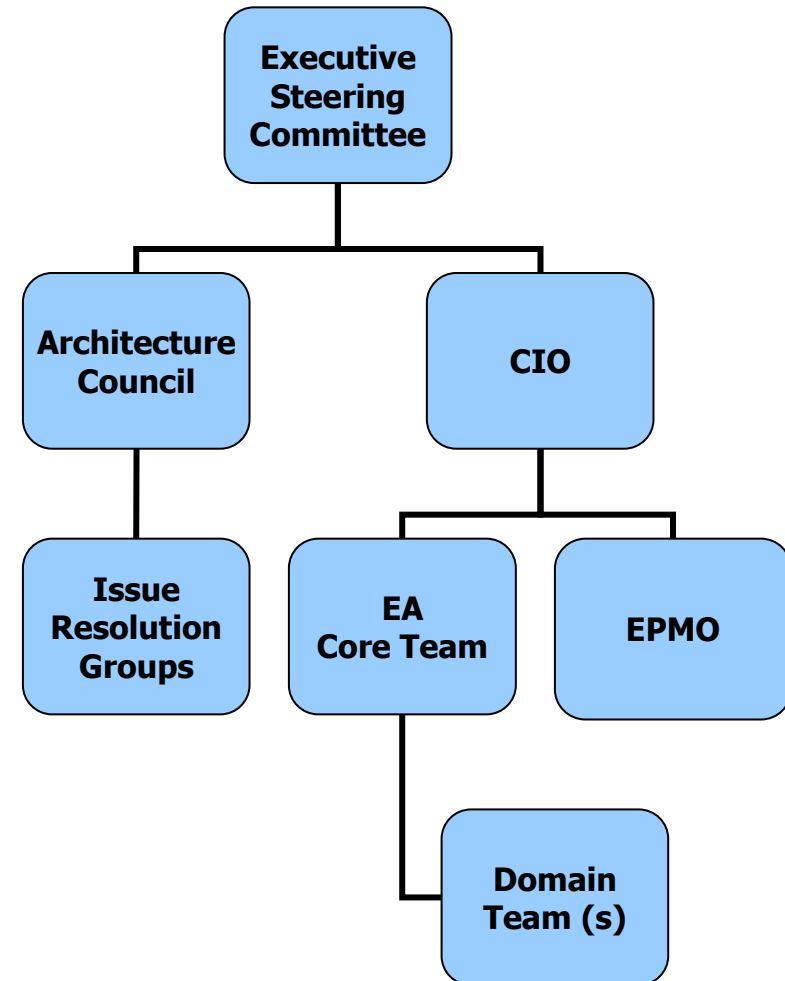
- Enterprise Governance is a consistent and interdependent system of **people**, **process**, and **policy** throughout the organization intended to ensure the **intentions of the enterprise leadership** are reflected in all decisions.
- PART 1 - Defines (approves) standards, policy, guidelines
- PART 2 - Must define consequences and apply them



**Missing EA Approval process is the primary cause for
EA Governance Failure!**

Sample Organization Structure

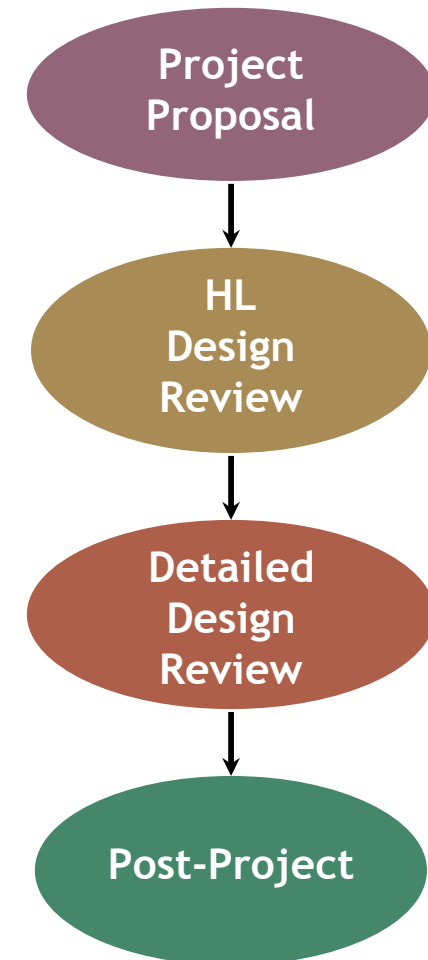
- **Combination EA/Governance org structure**
- **Would like to have cross-domain skills on each Domain Team**
- **Issue Resolution Groups are chartered as needed by Architecture Council**
- **Architecture Council members should be delegated authority by Steering Committee**
 - Mix of IT and business resources
- **Decisions get escalated to Steering Committee from Architecture Council**
- **Architecture Council ≠ EA Core Team**
 - EA Core Team is represented on ARB
- **EPMO takes on responsibility for EA compliance checks within SDLC**



- **Authority Flows Down**
 - Must be granted, cannot be assumed
 - EA Team has none
- **Committees are not debate societies**
 - Up/Down votes required
- **Establish committee protocols**
 - Membership Requirements/Proxy Rules
 - Notification/Comment/Action Periods
 - Quorum/Voting/Table/Veto Rules
 - Consensus, Majority (Simple, $\frac{3}{4}$, etc.)
 - Meeting Frequency
- **Areas of Responsibility**
 - ESC vs. Architecture Council
 - Escalation Rules
- **Formal Sign-off Ceremony**
- **Publish Results**

- **EA Team Informs/Advises Process**
 - PROACTIVE - Coaches/Consults Project Teams EARLY
 - Examines Projects for Compliance and identifies non-compliance concerns
 - No Authority to Grant Exceptions
 - Informs EPMO of concerns/implications
- **Projects request Exceptions/Variances from EPMO**
 - Should have the support of the EA Team
- **Governance Body (EPMO?) Manages Exception Process**
 - Integrates Compliance Process with SDLC(s)
 - Presents findings to Architecture Council
 - Council Escalates to ESC
 - Directs Project as to Outcomes
- **EA Team uses results of process to improve EA Content**
- **Metrics kept by EPMO, analyzed by EA Core Team**

Project Life Cycle Gates



- **Must install and evolve governance structures, membership and processes according to organization's ability to assimilate them**
 - Don't try to install too much too fast
- **Keep processes streamlined**
 - EA Compliance is the shortest, fastest path through SDLC
 - Lightweight interaction
- **Test approval and compliance processes with simple deliverables**
 - Iterate and enhance as you go
- **Expand governance membership up and across**
- **Add stages to compliance processes only as required**
- **Refine engagement models with projects**
 - Train EA-knowledgeable examiners to work with and evaluate projects

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- A very strong, detailed EA compliance process is critical
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Thank-You! (www.EAdirections.com)



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Larry R. DeBoever



Tim Westbrook

- **Founded by Larry R. DeBoever, George S. Paras, Tim Westbrook**
 - 50+ years of combined leadership in Enterprise Architecture
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